TCGA-BRCA: Gene Expression and PAM50 Visualization

Paul A. Skeffington

Master of Science in Health Data Science

Geisel School of Medicine at Dartmouth

Foundations in Data Science

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Instructor: Dr. Shira Fisher

Teaching Assistant: Erica Paulos

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Introduction

Breast cancer represents a major global public health dilemma requiring multinational synergy in research, and pharmaceutical development. In 2024, approximately 2.4 million women were diagnosed with breast cancer world-wide, with an estimated 694,000 associated deaths(World Health Organization, 2026). Despite advances in screening, and treatment, breast cancer remains a biologically heterogeneous disease, with considerable variable in molecular characteristic and clinical behavior.

Through the contribution of scientists globally, gene-expression research has identified distinct molecular subtypes, Luminal A, Luminal B, Her-2 enriched, and Basal-like breast cancers (Parker et al., 2009). The classifications demonstrate differences in tumor biology and give researcher a frame work for investigating variance in gene expressions. The Cancer Genome Atlas (TCGA), has established an extensive molecular database for investigating breast cancer heterogeneity (Cancer Genome Atlas Network, 2012).

Methods

We examine the supplied gene-expression matrix (`counts.csv`) and associated annotations (`meta_data.csv`). [State the verified data origin and assay, how sample identifiers were matched, the selected sample types, exclusions, and the exact subtype field.] [Describe any gene filtering, normalization or transformation, z-score calculation, and how genes were selected for visualization.] Descriptive summaries and a heatmap characterize the selected cohort. An illustrative volcano plot displays a specified between-group contrast; [state the actual comparison, computation of effect sizes and p-values, and any adjustment]. Unless a suitable count-based model was fitted, the contrast is descriptive rather than confirmatory (Benjamini & Hochberg, 1995; Love et al., 2014).

Results

[Report the final matched sample count and the molecular subtype distribution, including denominators and missing annotations.] [Report only reproducible descriptive findings from the expression summaries.] [Insert the final heatmap and briefly describe its most relevant visible patterns, noting that z-score tails are not significance tests.] [Insert the final volcano plot and identify the groups, axes, thresholds, and limitations; do not interpret illustrative highlights as validated differential expression.]

References

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